

TRUSTMRR DATASET ANALYSIS

The Indie Startup Revenue Landscape

A data-driven analysis of 1,000 bootstrapped and indie startups — revenue, growth, categories, geography, and monetization patterns.

Source: trustmrr.com startup dataset • 1,000 records • August 2026

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The dataset at a glance

1,000 startups listed on TrustMRR, spanning 65+ countries and 29 categories, report a combined \$13.47M in monthly recurring revenue.



1,000

Startups Tracked

across 65+ countries



\$13.47M

Combined MRR

monthly recurring revenue



\$133.75M

12-Month Revenue

trailing twelve months



500,597

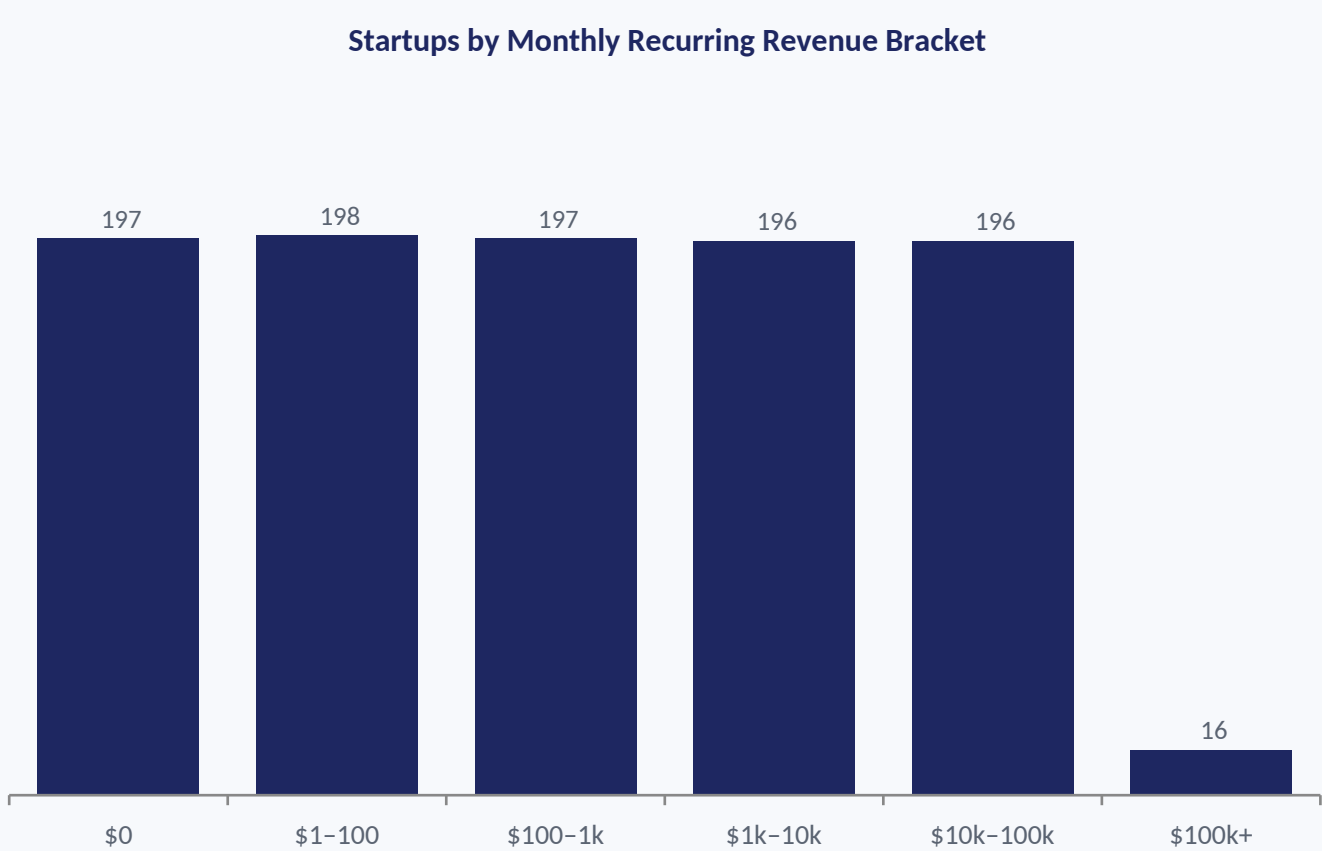
Active Subscriptions

across all startups

Median MRR across all 1,000 startups is just \$282 — the mean of \$13,472 is pulled up sharply by a small number of breakout performers, a pattern explored on the next slide.

REVENUE DISTRIBUTION

Revenue follows a steep power law



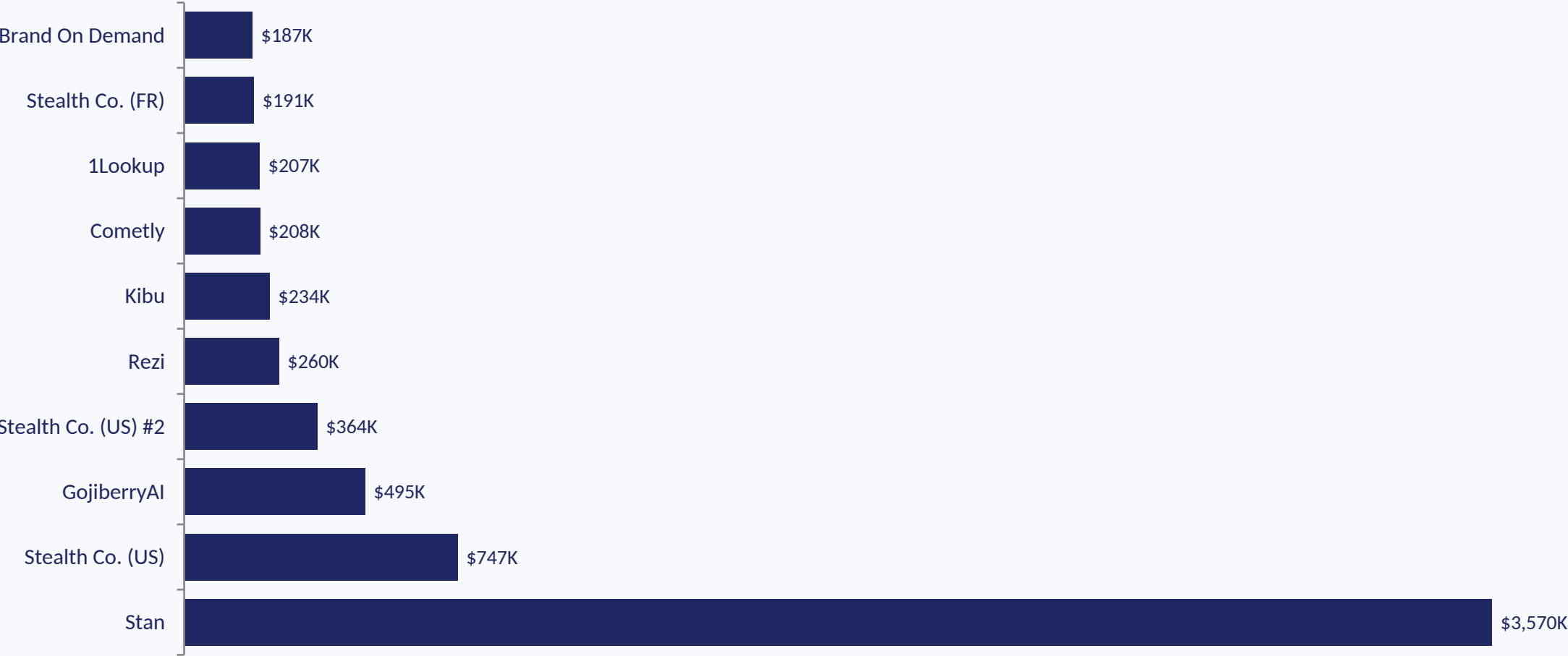
48% of all MRR comes from just the top 10 startups

70.6% of all MRR is concentrated in the top 50 startups

19.7% of startups (197 of 1,000) currently generate \$0 MRR

LEADERBOARD

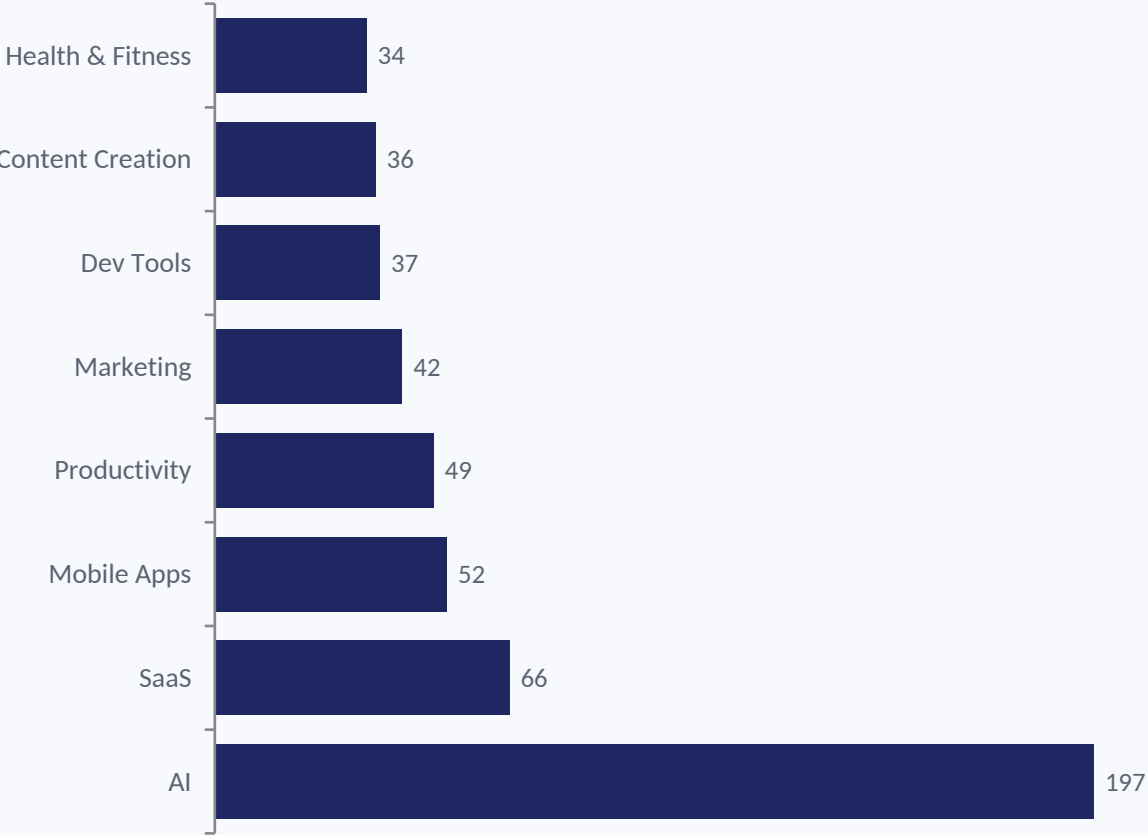
The top 10 startups by MRR



Stan alone accounts for 26.5% of the dataset's entire MRR (\$3.57M of \$13.47M) — a single outlier that shapes every aggregate figure in this analysis.

AI leads in both volume and revenue

Startup Count by Category (Top 8)



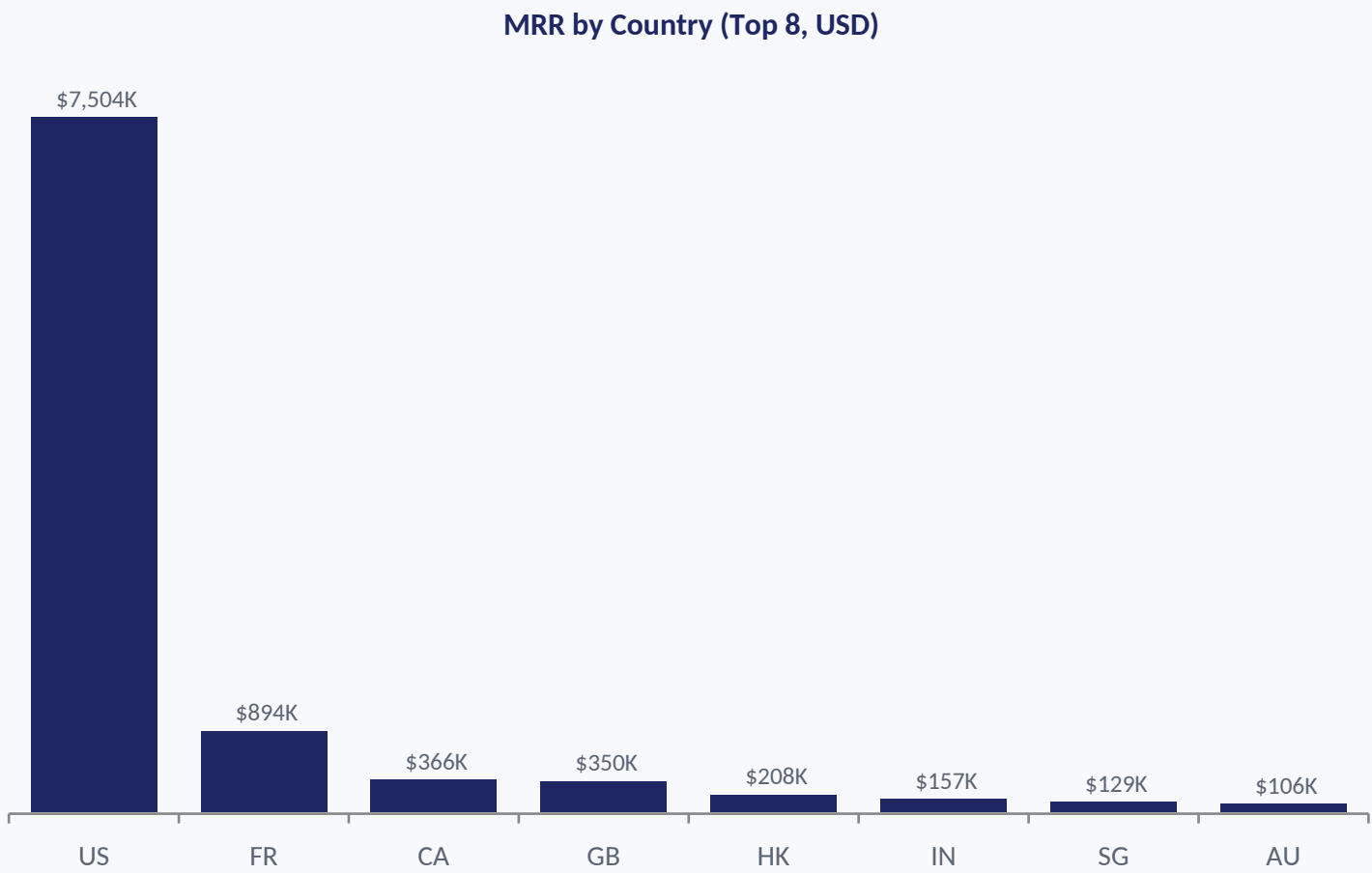
\$1.8M

AI category MRR — 13.4% of the entire dataset's revenue, generated by 197 startups (avg. \$9,167 MRR each).

Highest average MRR per startup

E-commerce	\$20,829 avg
Analytics	\$18,831 avg
Education	\$17,458 avg
Social Media	\$16,911 avg

The US dominates, but the long tail is global



258

US-based startups — more than the next 6 countries combined, and 55.7% of all tracked MRR (\$7.5M).

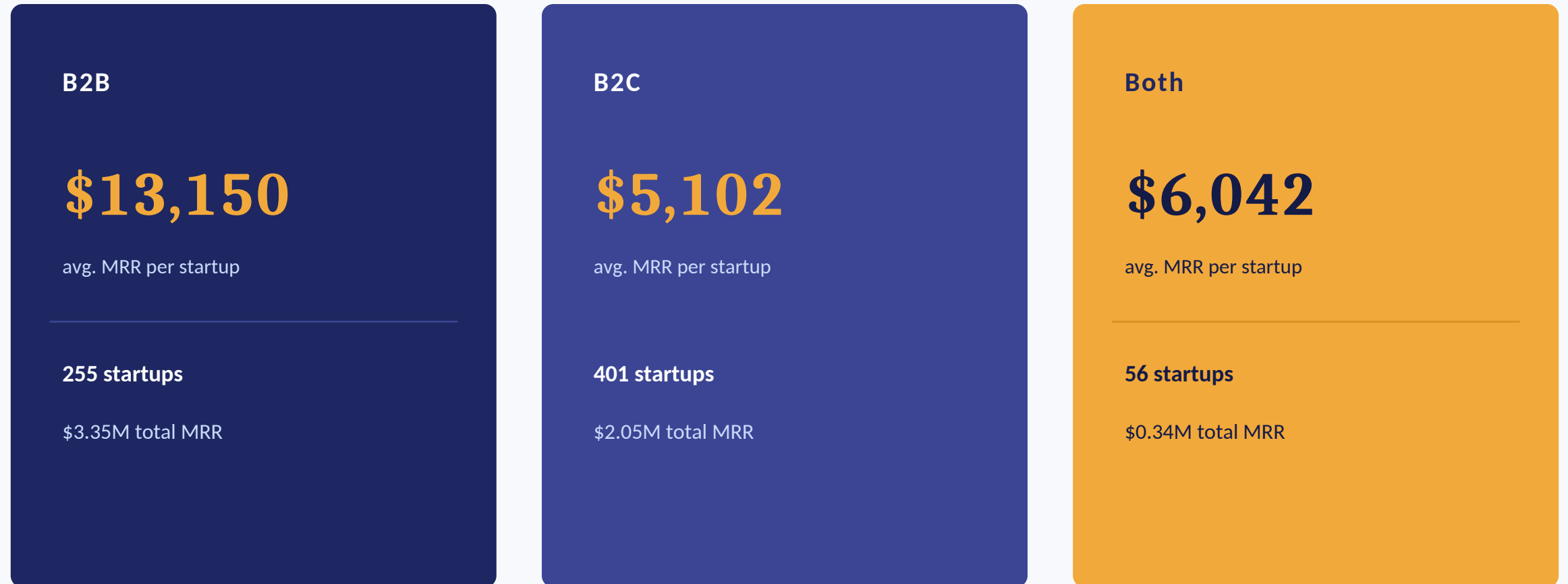
65+

countries represented in the dataset, with France, Canada, and the UK forming the next tier.

241 records

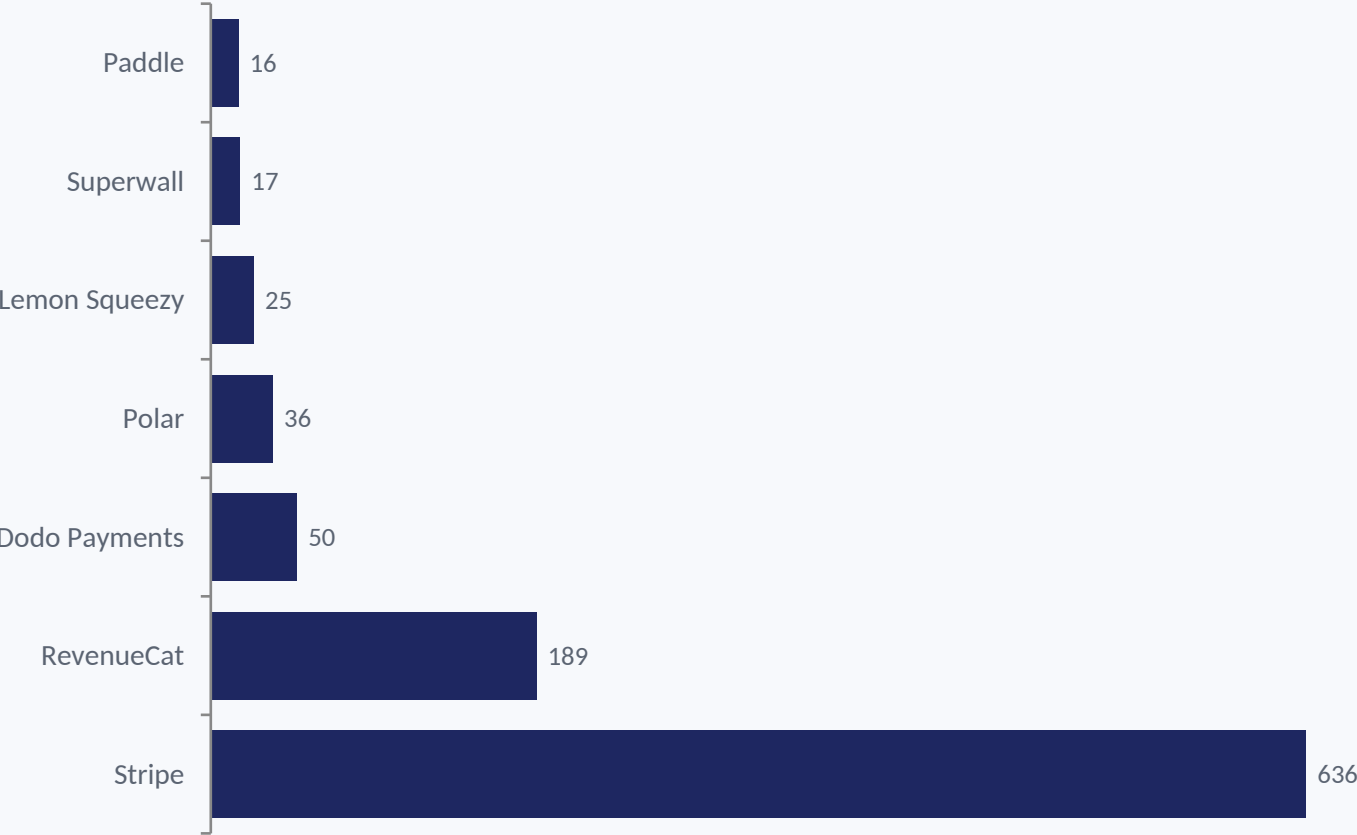
have no country listed, so true concentration outside the US may be somewhat understated.

B2B startups earn 2.6x more per business than B2C



Stripe processes the vast majority of tracked revenue

Startups by Payment Provider



63.6%

of startups use Stripe as a payment provider — accounting for \$11.75M of the dataset's \$13.47M MRR (87%).

RevenueCat, second most common

18.9% of startups (189) rely on RevenueCat — signaling a large share of mobile-first, subscription-app businesses in the dataset.

Fastest-growing startups (30-day MRR growth)

Limited to startups with more than \$1,000 in current MRR, to surface meaningful momentum rather than noise from tiny bases.

Startup	Category	MRR	30-Day Growth
Stealth Company	—	\$135,899	+12,983%
Stealth Company	—	\$35,517	+534%
LLM Gateway	AI	\$47,172	+240%
Hong Xuan Kow	AI	\$20,254	+459%
Kickly – Pronos IA	Games	\$10,236	+385%
Hidden Jobs	Recruiting & HR	\$1,076	+1,357%
HotelHero.ai	AI	\$1,460	+1,227%

Note: several "Stealth Company" entries mask true identity in the source data but are retained here as distinct records.

MARKETPLACE ACTIVITY

1 in 4 startups is listed for sale



262

Startups on sale

26.2% of the dataset



\$35,000

Median asking price

among listed startups



\$332,488

Average asking price

skewed by high-end listings

What this signals

A quarter of the dataset is actively for sale — consistent with a marketplace-sourced dataset where micro-SaaS founders list businesses for acquisition. Asking prices vary enormously (from \$0 to \$10M), reflecting a mix of near-dormant side projects and genuine revenue-generating businesses priced on a revenue-multiple basis.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

What the data tells us

1

Revenue is extremely concentrated

The top 10 startups hold 48% of all MRR; nearly 1 in 5 startups earns nothing at all.

3

B2B monetizes better than B2C

B2B startups average \$13,150 in MRR — 2.6x the average B2C startup.

5

Stripe is the default rail

63.6% of startups process payments through Stripe, covering 87% of dataset MRR.

2

AI is the largest category by far

197 startups (nearly 1 in 5) are AI-focused, generating \$1.8M in combined MRR.

4

The US anchors the ecosystem

258 startups and 55.7% of tracked MRR originate from the United States.

6

A quarter of listings are for sale

262 startups are actively listed, with a median asking price of \$35,000.